

Richard Álvarez

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About Me

Recent graduate with strong academic and practical background in data analytics and IT support. Experienced in generating reports, analyzing user needs, and troubleshooting systems. Looking to contribute to business analysis and customer experience through structured research and documentation.

Education

Kenyon College
Bachelor of Arts in Film; GPA: 3.4/4.0
Minor in History and Concentration in Integrated Program in Humane Studies
Relevant coursework includes Senior Research Seminar, AI for the Humanities, Advanced Post-Production, Data Structures and Program Design, Digital Photography, Sex, Drugs, Guns: Research Strategies in the Contemporary Age, and Software Development.
Completed multiple data-focused humanities courses including IPHS 200 "Programming Humanity," emphasizing Python, NLP, and data visualization in social and ethical contexts.

Gambier, Ohio
Aug 2020 – May 2024

Work Experience

LEGO STEM Instructor
Play-Well TEKnologies · Part-time
Taught STEM-focused LEGO classes to children, introducing engineering and problem-solving concepts through hands-on activities. Managed classroom engagement, ensured safety, and adapted instruction to diverse learning styles. Communicated effectively with parents and staff to provide updates and address concerns.

Chicago, Illinois
Oct 2024 – Dec 2024

IT Assistant
Library and Information Services (LBIS), Kenyon College · Part-time
I supported campus-wide technology needs by preparing workstations, moving office tech, and securely erasing and recycling equipment. I restocked printers daily and conducted classroom checks under the guidance of team members. I configured and troubleshooted printers and classroom AV systems including projectors and microphones. I created an automated spreadsheet mapping class times to maintenance windows, improving team scheduling.

Gambier, Ohio
Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Research Assistant
University of Chicago · Part-time
I worked under Bernard Dickens III on an academic paper proposing strategies to protect against supply-chain attacks and ensure file integrity using advanced checksum technologies. I attended monthly code reviews and contributed 27 commits to the repository.

Chicago, Illinois
Aug 2018 – Nov 2019

Publications

A Retrieval-Augmented Film Recommendation System | [GitHub](#) | [Digital Kenyon](#) | May 8th 2024
This project utilized LangChain's OpenAI integration to dynamically generate queries based on user preferences, showcasing the potential of advanced AI and machine learning in digital entertainment. The Retrieval-Augmented Film Recommendation System was developed using Node.js and integrated with the OMDb and TMDb APIs to enhance movie metadata, delivering precise and personalized recommendations.

Certificates

CompTIA ITF+ Sep 2024
CompTIA A+ In Progress

Skills

Technical Support: Windows 10/11, printer troubleshooting, PC imaging, secure data wiping, AV setup (projectors, mics), Zoom, Microsoft Teams, ticketing systems (e.g. ServiceNow)
Programming: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, C/C++, Tableau, regular expression
Frameworks: Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS, Scikit-Learn, Keras, pandas, NumPy, LangChain
Hardware: Workstation setup, printer maintenance, classroom AV gear, scanner/camera configuration

Websites

Machine Television <i>Online Store</i> Developed a functional e-commerce platform for an independent skate brand. The site was built using Next.js and Tailwind CSS for an intuitive front-end, paired with Node.js for a robust back-end infrastructure. Integrated Stripe API for seamless payment processing, optimizing user workflows across desktop and mobile.	Visit Site Oct 2024
Joaquin Morales <i>Portfolio</i> Designed and deployed a dynamic portfolio site for a professional cinematographer. The project used Next.js for high performance, with Tailwind CSS for responsive design. Implemented a custom CMS to enable efficient content updates, managing galleries and testimonials with ease. Leveraged DigitalOcean S3 storage for scalability and fast load times for video and photo content.	Visit Site Jan 2025
GREasyVocab Flashcards <i>Web App</i> Created a personalized GRE vocabulary tool powered by OpenAI's APIs. The application leverages LangChain to provide personalized prompts tailored to user inputted data. Developed a secure full-stack system with user authentication and database management, ensuring a smooth and customized learning experience.	Jul 2024

Portfolio

Editor <i>Freelance</i> - Indie Sleaze (2024) – Directed and produced senior thesis film, managing narrative structure and visual consistency. - Performing the Primitive (2023) – Reviewed footage for Sam Pack. - Summer Legal Scholar Recaps (2022) – Produced professional video content for Ric Sheffield, refining footage for clarity and engagement.	2022 – Present
Music Video Producer <i>Various Collaborations</i> - trees by GRAYS (2023) - Live, Laugh, Kill by JvneBvg (2022) - Rick and Morty by Black Yoshi (2021) - Poltergeist by Souley (2021) - No Rulez by InVoid (2021) - Ghosts by Undercurrent (2020)	2020 – Present
Script Supervisor <i>Jasmine</i> Maintained narrative and technical consistency on set.	July 2024
Production Assistant <i>Shopping for Superman</i> Assisted on-set logistics and maintained production schedules.	May 2024

Additional Projects

Unsupervised Deep Learning and PySceneDetect Analysis GitHub Digital Kenyon May 23rd 2023 This research focused on analyzing short-format video editing trends by leveraging PySceneDetect and unsupervised deep neural networks. Advanced data visualization techniques, including t-SNE and PCA, were employed to uncover patterns and gain insights into the editing styles and trends prevalent in the dataset.
AI-Driven Kubrick-Inspired Film Script Generation GitHub Designed and developed an AI pipeline to generate film scripts inspired by Stanley Kubrick's cinematic style. Leveraging Dust.tt and Large Language Models, I created a custom API to enable dynamic and stylistically consistent script generation. This project demonstrated the potential of generative AI for creative industries, producing scripts that emulated Kubrick's distinctive narrative and thematic characteristics.
Sentiment Analysis of Rotten Tomatoes Reviews GitHub Conducted a sentiment analysis of user reviews from Rotten Tomatoes to evaluate the psychology of movie consumers and the reliability of the platform's 'freshness' indicators. Using VADER and the NLTK library, I processed text data by filtering stop words, tokenizing reviews, and extracting sentiment scores. The analysis revealed that 73 of user reviews aligned with their assigned 'freshness' labels, validating both the reliability of Rotten Tomatoes user ratings and the effectiveness of the VADER sentiment analysis tool. Findings were presented in detailed visual reports, highlighting correlations between sentiment and user ratings.